

BARRELLING DOWN
A K9 Vajra self-propelled howitzer deployed along the LAC in Ladakh

DEFENCE

AIMING FOR INDEPENDENCE

By Pradip R. Sagar

The outcome of wars has been influenced by artillery for centuries. It retains its importance on the battlefield, as the conflict in Ukraine shows. Despite Indian artillery proving its mettle in the 1999 Kargil war, the Indian military has been short of firepower for over three decades. Corruption allegations over the procurement of the Bofors guns certainly had a paralysing effect on the modernisation of Indian artillery. But, finally, things seem to be back on track, as the army actively looks at adding more modern firepower to its artillery regiments. The focus is now on procuring these long-distance destroyers through the Make in India route.